Signal Planning Process

Quick briefing

Develop signal support requirements, allocate feasible resources, prepare for disruptions and validate the plan before publication.

Know the facts

Concurrent planning · Signal planning proceeds alongside the military decision-making process (MDMP) or troop leading procedures (TLP) at the appropriate level.

Requirements inputs · Use the commander’s priorities, staff and unit coordination, standard operating procedures, and applicable operating and standing instructions.

Resources and priorities · Check equipment readiness, actual personnel fill, training and funds. When resources are short, prioritize by supportability and importance to the mission.

Recovery procedures · Plan for interrupted connectivity and other disruptions, including redundant service, repair or replacement, and technical support.

Tentative plan · Allocate resources to requirements and outline primary, alternate, contingency and emergency support options.

Final checks and publication · Confirm coverage, responsibilities, resources, security and alignment with priorities. Publish the required diagrams and instructions with the plans and orders.

Understand the reasoning

A requirement and an allocation answer different questions. The requirement describes what the unit needs and the allocation shows what available resources can actually support.

A backup that depends on the same failed equipment or unavailable operator may offer little continuity. Test fallback assumptions against the disruption they are meant to cover.

Philippine Army classroom exercise

A fictional Philippine Army exercise has one trained operator available for two reporting desks. The first desk receives time-sensitive safety reports, while the second compiles routine attendance totals.

Decision · How should the plan allocate support and account for a temporary outage?

Worked analysis · Assign the trained operator to the safety desk and agree on a lower-demand schedule for attendance reporting. Document an authorized alternative for urgent safety messages and who will activate it. Before publication, rehearse the handoff and check that the remaining staff can carry it out.

How to practice

1 · Gather support requirements from the commander’s guidance, staff users, and participating units.

2 · Verify equipment, staffing, training and other resources, then rank requirements by mission importance and supportability.

3 · Draft an allocation with assigned responsibilities and workable alternatives for interruptions.

4 · Check the draft against priority needs, coverage, actual resources and security requirements.

5 · Resolve remaining decisions with the operations staff and publish the authorized plan with its supporting material.

Check yourself

What two considerations guide priorities when signal resources are insufficient? · Supportability and importance to mission accomplishment.

At which stage should the planner verify overall coverage, feasibility and responsibilities? · Finalizing the plan, before publication.

Course source

PAM 6-0102 · Signal Operations